In the days after the border was closed, and as the Wall's structure formalized, other cultural voices turned to Cold War Berlin without the switchback to the lines dividing the United States. For example, episodes of NBC's *Jack Paar Show* and CBS's *Ed Sullivan Show* and *Armstrong Circle Theatre*'s "Chapter on Tyranny: Dateline Berlin" featured a mix of reportage and entertainment and interactions with members of the military and refugees or, in the case of the latter, presented dramatized reenactments of escape attempts. A focus on the daring escapes of East Germans away from communist rule and toward the West in these productions was influenced not only by the perspective of American media—their reports were literally filed in the West—but also by American cultural figures who flocked to West Berlin to help make sense of the situation and broadcast televised images of themselves in the city. These efforts not only bridged the distance between "here" and "there" but also failed to draw reflexive comparisons. They most often were captured from within the circuits of mainstream cultural diplomacy, underwritten by U.S. military presence and support in West Berlin.[13] Others, without setting foot in Berlin, located popular expressions in divided Berlin as a means to conjure division as a symbolic condition.[14]

From the tense moments of the Berlin Crisis, some of the first press photographs of the border scene that circulated around the globe were of East German border troops, either building the border or escaping it. On August 15, 1961, Peter Leibing photographed East German corporal Conrad Schumann taking a running leap over the barbed wire blocking the border while throwing his rifle off his shoulder. A photograph showing this "leap of freedom" soon appeared on the front page of the West German *Bild* newspaper and was soon reprinted in papers across the world.[15] For western viewers, their vision of the Wall through this photograph was simultaneously one of enclosure and potential—albeit challenged—escape. Yet the full narrative of the image is not self-apparent. The civilians in the background of this iconic image, pictured in soft focus, stand casually. One figure appears to have his hand in his pocket, in contrast to the urgency of a soldier fleeing a war zone. The presence of another photographer's upheld camera in the frame reinforces the proximity and power of photography mediating views of the scene. The clashing perspectives of these two characters replicate the sense of East Berlin as decidedly strange and West Berlin as the visual norm of freedom.[16]